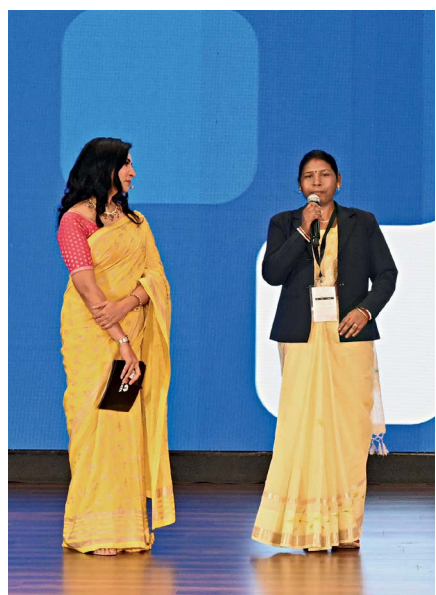




(Left) Former Union Minister **Smriti Irani** at the Tata AI Sakhi Immersion Program



Participants at the Tata AI Sakhi Immersion Program and Tata Bharat YUVAi Hackathon

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ised by Tata Consultancy Services (TCS) aimed at empowering around 2,000 non-engineering undergraduates — many without prior coding experience—to use voice-first, multilingual AI tools to build solutions for sectors such as healthcare, education, agriculture, and civic services.

The TCS YUVAi Hackathon is designed to democratise AI learning, said Krithivasan. “We want to make AI learning accessible to every student, not only for engineers. We believe AI empowers all, not just the engineers, and that’s the idea of this hackathon. We intend to scale this programme to reach 1 million students over the next few months.”

Ashok Krish, VP & Head, AI Practices, TCS, called it the world’s largest hackathon for non-coders. “We deliberately picked college students who have never coded in their lives. We are telling them you can build technology. AI will help you do that. The more important thing is knowing what problem to solve,” said Krish.

“In 2 hours, 2,000 students discovered something that they knew they couldn’t do: go from a problem statement to a working application in under 2 hours. Everybody thinks you need a developer, a team of engineer and a lot of expensive technology to do it,” Krish highlighted. **BT**

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